

Across Borders: The First Promise

跨越边界：第一次承诺

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The first promise of the fifth arc was made on a **Sunday**, near the **bottom** of a **hill**, under the **roof** of a station cafe. “We **proceed through** the exchange office,” Aisha said. “**Through**, not around.” A **visa**, a **tight** connection, and a **loose** plan were the whole of it, and the **run** of the first week was worse than any of them had feared.

The field was new, and the industry was not. An **immigrant** family ran a **parking** service near the **airline** counter; their **van**, their **bike**, and their **carriage** were the only transport for a hundred metres. “A **cab** is not a **decoration**,” the **mistress** of the house said. “It is a **roof**.”

The **distant** hills were on the **television** in the lounge, and the **overhead** lights of the **carriage** stayed on all night. “A **homeless** man understands the **interior** of a station better than any engineer,” she said. “That is a **familiarity** we cannot buy.”

The **bark** of a dog, a **procession** of claps, and the **countdown** to a **spacecraft** launch: the cafe **television** had everything except the **freight** timetable. “It is **ridiculous**,” Lin said, “that a **starter** can find the **fuel** but not the train.” The trip, for him, was over before it began.

They would **relax** for one evening, then **smash** the last problem: a **hijack** of the schedule by a **cruiser** of tourists who had bought every seat. “Any business has a special month,” Aisha said. “This is ours, and it matters particularly to the office in the capital.” A note in the margin said: “I must say that we are still far from the offer,” and it is likely that the **baggage** rules will change today; a passenger cannot **comprehend** a rule that the staff themselves cannot **restrain**. It was possible that a **ragged** timetable would never be **intimate** with a stranger's need; the trip had taught them that much. A **distant hill**, a **tight** connection, and a **loose** plan: the pattern of the whole arc was already visible in the first **Sunday** afternoon of the journey. It was, in the end, a promise about the use of a timetable.

中文翻译

第五段弧线的第一个承诺是在一个星期天做出的，在山脚附近、车站咖啡馆的屋檐下。“我们通过兑换办公室走，”艾莎说，“是穿过，不是绕开。”一张签证、一次紧张的换乘和一个松散的方案就是全部内容，而第一周的那种奔跑比他们任何人担心的都糟。

这个领域是新的，行业却不是。一户移民家庭在航空公司柜台旁经营着一项停车服务；他们的货车、自行车和马车是一百米之内唯一的交通方式。“出租车不是装饰，”那家房屋的女主人说，“它是一片屋顶。”

休息室里电视上放着远处的山丘，车厢顶灯整夜亮着。“一个无家可归的人比任何工程师都更懂车站的内部，”她说，“这是一种我们买不到的熟悉感。”

一条狗的吠叫、一阵掌声的队列，以及航天飞船发射的倒计时：咖啡馆的电视什么都有，只没有货运时刻表。“太荒谬了，”林伟说，“新手找得到燃料，却找不到火车。”对他来说，这趟旅程还没开始就结束了。

他们会放松一个晚上，然后击碎最后一个问题：一船游客买下了所有座位，劫持了整张时刻表。“任何生意都有它的特殊月份，”艾莎说，“这就是我们的，而且对首都那间办公室尤其重要。”页边的一条注记写着：“我必须说我们离那份报价还很远。”，而且行李规定很可能今天就变；一名乘客无法理解一条连工作人员自己都无法约束的规则。一张粗糙的时刻表，也许永远不会与一个陌生人的需要亲密无间；这趟旅程至少教会了他们这一点。一座远处的山、一次紧凑的换乘、一个松散的计划：整段弧线的图案，在旅程的第一个周日下午就已经看得见了。说到底，这是一个关于如何使用时刻表的承诺。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
through θru: POS: adv	adv. 穿越, 从头至尾, 到底, 因为; prep. 经过, 穿过; a. 对穿的, 直达的, 完结的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (of a route or journey etc.) continuing without requiring stops or changes; r. from beginning to end; r. over...
run rʌn POS: n	n. 跑, 赛跑, 奔跑, 奔跑的路程, 趋向, 流出, 运转时间, 连续; vi. 跑, 奔跑, 跑步, 赛跑, 竞赛, 行驶, 运转, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a score in baseball made by a runner touching all four bases safely; n. (American football) a play in which...
far fɑ: POS: a	a. 远的, 久远的, 遥远的; adv. 甚远地, 很, 到很深的程度, 到很远的距离 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. located at a great distance in time or space or degree; s. being of a considerable distance or length; s. be...
near niə POS: a	a. 近的, 近亲的, 近似的; adv. 接近, 亲近; prep. 靠近, 近似于; v. 接近, 走近 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not far distant in time or space or degree or circumstances; s. being on the left side; s. closely resemblin...
television ˈteli.vɪʒən POS: n	n. 电视; [电] 电视 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. broadcasting visual images of stationary or moving objects; n. a telecommunication system that transmits im...
Sunday ˈsʌndi POS: n	n. 星期日; a. 星期日的, 业余的; vi. 度星期日 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. first day of the week; observed as a day of rest and worship by most Christians; n. United States evangelis...
hill hil POS: n	n. 小山, 丘陵, 小土堆; vt. 作成土堆, 堆成小丘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a local and well-defined elevation of the land; n. United States railroad tycoon (1838-1916); n. risque Engl...
bottom ˈbɒtəm POS: n	n. 底部; a. 底部的; vt. 给...装底, 查明真相; vi. 到达底部, 建立基础 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the lower side of anything; n. the lowest part of anything; n. the second half of an inning; while the home...
fuel ˈfjuəl POS: n	n. 燃料, 木炭; vt. 加燃料, 供燃料; vi. 得到燃料 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a substance that can be consumed to produce energy; v. provide with a combustible substance that provides e...
roof ru:f POS: n	n. 屋顶, 室顶; vt. 给...盖屋顶, 遮蔽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a protective covering that covers or forms the top of a building; n. protective covering on top of a motor...
immigrant ˈɪmɪgrənt POS: n	n. 移民; a. 移入的, 移民的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who comes to a country where they were not born in order to settle there
proceed prəʊˈsi:d POS: vi	vi. 继续进行, 进行, 开始, 发出, 起诉; [法] 所得, 收入, 收益 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move ahead; travel onward in time or space; v. follow a certain course
airline ˈeəlaɪn POS: n	n. 航线, 航线的设备, 航空公司 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hose that carries air under pressure; n. a commercial enterprise that provides scheduled flights for pass...
bike baɪk POS: n	n. 自行车, 脚踏车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a motor vehicle with two wheels and a strong frame; n. a wheeled vehicle that has two wheels and is moved by...
parking ˈpɑ:kɪŋ POS: n	n. 停车; a. 停车的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. space in which vehicles can be parked; n. the act of maneuvering a vehicle into a location where it can be...
relax rɪˈlæks POS: vi	vi. 放松, 松懈, 松弛, 变从容, 休息, 休养; vt. 使松弛, 缓和, 使松懈, 使休息 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become less tense, rest, or take one's ease; v. make less taut; v. cause to feel relaxed; v. become less tens...
distant ˈdɪstənt POS: a	a. 远的, 疏远的; [经] 远期的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. separated in space or coming from or going to a distance; a. far apart in relevance or relationship or kins...
tight taɪt POS: a	a. 紧的, 密封的, 吝啬的, 严厉的; adv. 紧紧地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. closely constrained or constricted or constricting; s. set so close together as to be invulnerable to penet...
loose lu:s POS: n	n. 发射, 放任, 放纵; a. 宽松的, 松的, 宽的, 不牢固的, 散漫的, 自由的, 不精确的; vt. 释放, 放枪, 开船; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not compact or dense in structure or arrangement; s. (of a ball in sport) not in the possession or control...
van væn POS: n	n. 货车, 篷车, 先锋, 前驱, 前卫; vt. 用货车搬运; [计] 增值网 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (Great Britain) a closed railroad car that carries baggage or freight; n. a camper equipped with living qua...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
carriage 'kæridʒ POS: n	n. 马车, 客车, 举止, 运输; [经] 搬运费, 运费 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a vehicle with wheels drawn by one or more horses; n. characteristic way of bearing one's body; n. a machine...
interior in'tiəriə POS: n	n. 内部, 内政; a. 内部的, 心灵的, 内地的, 内政的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. situated within or suitable for inside a building; s. inside and toward a center; s. of or coming from the m...
homeless 'həumlis POS: a	a. 无家的, 无养主的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone unfortunate without housing; n. poor people who unfortunately do not have a home to live in; s. with...
ridiculous ri'dikjələs POS: a	a. 荒谬的, 可笑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. inspiring scornful pity; s. incongruous; inviting ridicule; s. broadly or extravagantly humorous; resembling fa...
starter 'stɑ:tə POS: n	n. 开端者, 在起跑线上的人, 参加赛跑的人, 调度员, 起动机, 酵母; [计] 启动程序, 启动器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an electric motor for starting an engine; n. a contestant in a team sport who is in the game at the beginni...
cab kæb POS: n	n. 出租车, 出租汽车, 出租马车; vi. 乘出租车(或汽车) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a compartment at the front of a motor vehicle or locomotive where driver sits; n. small two-wheeled horse-d...
intimate 'intimət POS: a	a. 亲密的, 私人的, 秘密的; vt. 暗示, 通知, 告诉; n. 至交 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give to understand; s. marked by close acquaintance, association, or familiarity; s. involved in a sexual re...
smash smæʃ POS: n	n. 打碎, 粉碎, 打碎时哗啦声, 猛击, 扣球, 杀球, 经营失败, 破产, 硬币, 假硬币; a. 非常轰动的, 了不起的; vt. 打... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a serious collision (especially of motor vehicles); v. hit hard; v. break into pieces, as by striking or kno...
decoration 'deke'reiʃən POS: n	n. 装饰, 装饰品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something used to beautify; n. an award for winning a championship or commemorating some other event; n. the...
mistress 'mistris POS: n	n. 主妇, 女主人, 情妇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adulterous woman; a woman who has an ongoing extramarital sexual relationship with a man; n. a woman mas...
visa 'vi:zə POS: n	n. 签证; vt. 签发 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an endorsement made in a passport that allows the bearer to enter the country issuing it; v. provide (a pas...
overhead 'əuvəhed POS: n	n. 经常开支, 普通费用, 天花板; a. 在头上的, 高架的; adv. 在头顶上, 在空中, 在高处, 从头到脚全部没入地; [计] 总开... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (nautical) the top surface of an enclosed space on a ship; n. a hard return hitting the tennis ball above y...
restrain ri'strein POS: vt	vt. 抑制, 阻止, 束缚; [法] 抑制, 遏制, 制止 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. keep under control; keep in check; v. to close within bounds, limit or hold back from movement; v. hold back
freight 'freit POS: n	n. 船货, 运费, 货运; vt. 装货, 使充满, 以货运运送, 租(或出租)(船等) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. transporting goods commercially at rates cheaper than express rates; n. the charge for transporting somethi...
bark bɑ:k POS: n	n. 树皮, 吠声; vi. 吠, 叫骂; vt. 喊出, 剥树皮 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. tough protective covering of the woody stems and roots of trees and other woody plants; n. a noise resembli...
procession prə'seʃən POS: n	n. 队伍, 连续, 列队行进, 涌出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the group action of a collection of people or animals or vehicles moving ahead in more or less regular for...
spacecraft 'speiskræft POS: n	n. 航天飞船 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a craft capable of traveling in outer space; technically, a satellite around the sun
clap klæp POS: n	n. 拍手, 拍手声, 霹雳声, 花柳病; v. 鼓掌, (使)啪地关上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put quickly or forcibly; v. cause to strike the air in flight; v. clap one's hands together; v. strike the ai...
comprehend 'kompri'hend POS: vt	vt. 理解, 包括 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v get the meaning of something; v to become aware of through the senses; v include in scope; include as part of...
baggage 'bægidʒ POS: n	n. 行李; [经] 行李 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cases used to carry belongings when traveling; n. a worthless or immoral woman; n. the portable equipment an...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
cruiser 'kru:zə POS: n	n. 巡洋舰, 巡航飞机, 警察巡逻车 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a car in which policemen cruise the streets; equipped with radiotelephonic communications to headquarters; ...
ragged 'ræɡɪd POS: a	a. 衣衫褴褛的, 参差不齐的, 不协调的, 粗糙的, 刺耳的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being or dressed in clothes that are worn or torn; s. worn out from stress or strain; s. having an irregular...
familiarity fe.mi.li'ærɪti POS: n	n. 熟悉, 精通, 亲密 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. usualness by virtue of being familiar or well known; n. close or warm friendship; n. an act of undue intimacy
hijack 'haɪdʒæk POS: vt	vt. 抢劫, 劫持, 敲诈; [法] 挡路抢劫, 抢劫, 绑架 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. seizure of a vehicle in transit either to rob it or divert it to an alternate destination; v. seize control...
countdown 'kauntdaʊn POS: n	n. 倒计时; [电] 指示串联中的操作数固定的记录减少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. counting backward from an arbitrary number to indicate the time remaining before some event (such as launch...